Introduction to Technical English II

Lecture 1

Definition of Technical English:

Technical English is the use of English language in technical fields such as computer science, engineering, and technology.

Technical English is the English used in science, engineering, and computer fields. It focuses on clarity, accuracy, and technical vocabulary.

Technical English is the form of English used in scientific, engineering, and computing fields. It emphasizes clarity, accuracy, and technical vocabulary — in short, a way to explain technical information without ambiguity.

Compare Between General vs. Technical English:

General English:

is the English used in daily life communication.

Technical English:

is the English used in scientific and technical fields.

Importance of English in the Technical Field:

1. Understanding technical books and references

Most computer science books are written in English. English helps you read textbooks, research papers, and technical documents.

2. Using software and applications.

Most software interfaces use English language. English helps you understand menus, commands, and Instructions in programs.

3. Understanding technical terms

Technical fields use many English terms such as database, network, and algorithm.

What is Technical Vocabulary?

Technical Vocabulary is the specialized vocabulary of any field which evolves due to the need for experts in a field to communicate with clarity, precision, relevance and brevity. Prior to developing your technical vocabulary, to improve your general vocabulary in English is very essential. The thirst to learn new words, should be a continuous process; whenever you learn new words, try your best to use them while you communicate so that the words register in your mind. There are different strategies you can adopt to learn the words. Learn by knowing their origin. A dictionary is an invaluable tool to build your vocabulary. Sometimes you infer the meaning of a word from the context; but the meaning may not be exact.

✓Once you have learnt to use the dictionary, you can improve your vocabulary in various ways. The most important one is word formation. Some of the methods of word formation are blending, compounding, coinage, borrowing clipping, etc.

✓It is only in the process of derivation, the form of the word changes. This derivation takes place with the help of affixes. Small bits of the English language are affixed to root words. Some of the affixes are un, mis, pre, ful, less, etc. Affixes can be divided into two categories:

- Prefixes
- Suffixes.

VOICE AND TENSE: ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE:

Look at the following sentences

1. **The operators conducted a test on the turbo generator.**

2. **A test was conducted on the turbo generator by the operators.**

You may observe in the first sentence the subject – (the operators) **perform the action** of the verb – (conducted). On the other hand, in the second sentence, the same subject **receives the action** of the verb. In other words, the former gives importance to the agent or the doer of the action. The verb “conducted” in the first sentence is a descriptive, action packed verb and is in active form. Hence this sentence is said to be in **Active Voice**. On the other hand, the verb “was conducted” containing an auxiliary verb “was” is.**inPassive Voice**

In grammar, the term **voice** is used to show the two different ways in which an action can be viewed – **1.** Someone or something performing an action and **2.** the action is being performed on someone or something.

Whenever we talk about a verb denoting an action, we also need to talk about the time at/during which the action occurs. This sense of time is reflected through the tense, a concept very fundamental to the grammar of any language. You might have observed in the sample sentences that there is a strong link between the voice of the verb and the tense.

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Tense/Verb	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Simple present	Analyses	is analysed
Present continuous	is analyzing	is being analysed
Simple past	Analysed	was analysed
Past continuous	was analysing	was being analysed
Present Perfect	has analysed	has been analysed
Future	will analyse	will analyse
Conditional	would analyse	would analyse
Perfect conditional	would have analysed	would have been analysed

As already mentioned the focus (agent or action) is different in the two voices. But you must be able to use both effectively in your academic writing. Though many a time, the action gets more emphasis in scientific or technical writing, sometimes the doer gets importance as shown in the following examples. The project was completed on time (focus is on the project) Sohan’s team completed the project on time (focus is on Sohan’s team) .

Let us review the steps involved in this process.

Changing Active Voice into Passive Voice

- Identify the subject (agent or thing that is causing the action) – who performed.
- Identify the object (what action has been done – performed what)
- Note the tense of the verb.
- Begin the passive sentence with the action (object of the active sentence)
- Use the third form of the verb (past participle) preceded by the appropriate auxiliary verb and followed by the phrase “by the”
- Complete the changed sentence with the agent or thing (subject of the active sentence).

Changing Passive Voice into Active

- Identify the doer/agent by noting carefully what follows the “by the..” phrase. If the agent is not specified, you may infer the agent from the action or context given in the following tables.
- Note down the action performed by the agent. (beginning of the passive sentence)
- Note the tense of the verb.
- Begin the active sentence with the agent.
- Choose the appropriate form of the verb according to the singular or plural form of the agent and the Simple Continuous, or perfect form of the tense of the verb.

Passive Voice	Agent	Active Voice
Multifarious operations are performed by these computers.	These computers	These computers perform multifarious operations.
The equipment for the practical examinations was being arranged by the technician.	Technician	The technician was arranging the equipment for the practical examinations.
Results will be published in the next issue of the journal.	Agent is not specified. It may be 'researchers' or the 'association'.	The researchers will publish the results in the next issue of the journal.
The components were identified by Thomas and his associates.	Thomas and his associates.	Thomas and his associates identified the components.

More examples for active and passive voice sentences in different Tenses are given below

Simple Present Tense

Active – We add water to mixture

Passive – Water is added to the mixture (by us)

Simple Past Tense

Active – The Civil Engineers tried out different layouts.

Passive – Different layouts were tried out by the Civil Engineers.

Simple Future Tense

Active – We will not carry out any research in this area.

Passive – No research will be carried out in this area.

Present Perfect Tense

Active – The Committee has approved the Plan.

Passive – The Plan has been approved by the Committee.

Past Perfect Tense

Active – The Engineers had completed the job in time.

Passive – The job had been completed in time by the Engineers.

Present continuous and Past Continuous

Active – They are repairing the road.

Passive – The road is being repaired.

When to use Active Voice:

While the doer is given importance in the active voice, the action gets prominence in the Passive Voice. Active Voice is used for clear, direct and strong writing and therefore requires active verbs.

When to use Passive Voice:

Passive Voice is used in most formal writings such as reports, proposals and complaints or rejection letters, because the action and not the doer (is important) needs to be given emphasis. Remember all sentences cannot be transformed from active into passive voice. Only transitive verbs (which takes an object) can be transformed into passive voice

To sum up the discussion on Voice and Tense, we can say that the tense of the verb undergoes a change when you transfer one voice into another. Passive construction is verbose while active is crisp, direct and unambiguous.

Thank You

NOTE MAKING

Lecture 2

Note Making

- Note making can be defined as a systematic method of writing down quickly, briefly and
- clearly the important points of reading a text. It is a productive skill which integrates both
- reading and writing skills.

Note making is used to

- Keep a record of the main points of a reading text for future use and reference
- Revise for an exam
- Update information

Reading strategy:

- A careful reading plan is to identify the central idea, important points and supporting
- details. It would enable you to understand the text quickly and make appropriate notes.

- ➢ Recognize the key lexical items related to the topic
- ➢ Identify the relationships among the units within the text
- ➢ Read the key points and signal words
- ➢ Ignore irrelevant matter and concentrate on the main parts
- ➢ Deduce meanings of words and phrases from their context and infer relationships
- ➢ Interpret graphic aids used in the text

How to make notes?

- Read the passage carefully
- Heading

What is the main idea of the passage? Frame a heading based on the central idea

and write it in the middle of the page

- Subheadings

How was the main idea being presented and developed?

Are there two or three subordinate ideas?

You can frame subheadings based on these

.

❖ Points

Are there further details or points of the subtitles that you wish to keep in the

notes?

All subheadings should be written at a uniform distance from the margin with

indent i.e. with suitable space and number

Indenting:

Do not write full sentences. Use abbreviations wherever necessary. Help with abbreviations.

1) **Use standard abbreviations and symbols**

Capitalized first letters of words

Ex: U.P., USA, USSR, UK

Common abbreviations

Ex: Sc (Science), Geog (Geography), Mr, Mrs, Dr, Govt

2) **Write the first few and last few letters of a word with an apostrophe in between** .can't(**cannot**) w'out(**without**), wrt'g (**writing**).

3) Use the first letters of the phrases

Kilogram Kg

Per annum P A

Curriculum Vitae CV

4) Use the first few letters of words or phrases

Approximately Approx

Difference Diff

Professor Prof

5) Generally used abbreviations

e.g. Example

viz Namely

et al and others

N.B. Take note that

Three methods of note making:

- ❑ Topicalising.
- ❑ schematting .
- ❑ Sequencing.

Topicalising:

Main points and central idea should be rephrased in points. Redundant words and phrases are to be removed

chematizing:

Scientific and technical texts may contain forms or figures, classification, contrasts, processes and so on. So we can schematize notes i.e. organize notes in the form of tables and diagram

Sequencing:

Sequencing refers to the process of making a clear layout for fast and accurate interpretation of notes.

How do you summarize?

Summarizing is a skill which is essential in many facets of your life. In this technology driven world, everybody values time and hence the art of condensation whereby you give brief account that saves a lot of time. Summary provides maximum information in minimum number of words. Summarizing improves our ability to write concisely by making us aware of the kind of details that can be avoided to achieve precision.

The five C's are very important to summarize: completeness, compactness, conciseness, clarity and coherence.

- ❑ The summary must have all the essential elements/contents of the original.
- ✓ All the ideas should form a compact whole. Unity is important.
- ✓ Brevity is the soul of wit. All the ideas should be clear and concise.
- ✓ Clarity of expression is very essential. No vague statements.
- ❑ All the sentences/ideas should have logical, chronological and spatial order. The linking of ideas should be coherent.

Summarizing, like note making is a productive skill integrating both reading and writing skills. To write effective summaries you need to read the material carefully with good comprehension

Thank You

COMPOUND NOUNS – NEGATIVE PREFIXES

Lecture 3

ANTONYMS – USE OF MODAL VERBS

- A noun is the part of speech which names a person, an animal, place, a thing or a quality of a thing. It can be further classified into abstract noun, collective noun, common noun, compound noun, concrete noun, countable noun, uncountable noun, gerund noun and proper noun.

Common noun – girl, boy, woman, book, town, country

Abstract noun – honesty, charity, wisdom

Collective noun – crowd, fleet, team, group

Concrete noun – iron, gold, silver

Countable noun – refers to things that can be counted; pens, chairs, people, car. They can be singular or plural.

Uncountable noun - sugar

Proper nouns - names; Sita, Rama, Madras, Delhi

Gerund nouns - nouns that are formed from a verb by adding ‘ing” are called gerund nouns; It can follow a verb, preposition or adjective; I love singing

A compound noun

- **is an expression which is made up of more than one word and functions as a noun.**
- **They are formed by nouns modified by adjectives or nouns. Most frequently they are combination of two**
- **nouns like bank-account, baby-sitter, letter-box, etc.**

- Black bird – adjective+noun
- Under-water – preposition+noun
- Hair cut – noun+verb

They can be written as one word or with hyphen in between or as two separate words.

- Tin opener – just separate words
- Pen-name – hyphen in between
- Earring – one word

- Compound nouns may be countable, uncountable or only used in singular or the plural.

Common Countable Compound Nouns:

- Tea-bag, contact lens, credit card, food token, hand cuffs, windscreen

Common Uncountable Compound Nouns:

- Income-tax, data-processing, family-planning, pocket money, swine-flu, fast-food

Compound nouns used only in Singular:

Generation-gap, brain drain, mother-tongue, labour force, death-penalty, blood-pressure Compound

Nouns used only in the plural:

Roadworks, traffic-lights, dancing shoes, sun-glasses, human rights

PREFIXES

- Prefixes are often used to give adjectives a negative meaning. The opposite of ‘similar is dissimilar. The opposite of kind is unkind. Opposite of decent is indecent. Opposite of obedient is disobedient. Unfortunately, there is no easy way of knowing which prefix any adjective will use to form the opposite. When you learn a new adjective note down whether it has an opposite formed with a prefix and if so what it is.

Some rules to remember:

- in- becomes im- before a root beginning with ‘m’ or ‘p’, e.g., immature, impatient, improbable.
- Similarly in- becomes ir- before a word beginning with ‘r’ and il- before a word beginning with ‘l’, e.g., irreplaceable, irreversible, illegal, illegible, illiterate.
- The prefix in- does not always have a negative meaning, often it gives the idea of inside or into, e.g., impart, internal, insert, income

- Although it is mainly adjectives, that are made negative by prefixes, in- and dis- can also form the opposites of verbs too, e.g., appear – disappear. The prefix is used here to reverse the action of the verb. Here are some more examples – disagree, disapprove, disbelieve, disconnect, discredit, dislike, dismount, disqualify, unbend, undo, undress, unfold, unload, unlock, unveil, unwrap, unzip.

- Reversative Prefixes:

These prefixes have the meaning reversal of action indicated by the base. They do not have negative implication un-, de-, dis-. e.g., undo, untie, unpack, dehydrate, decode, defrost, decentralise, disown.

- **Perforative Prefixes:**

These prefixes give the sense ill, bad, wrong, wrongly, not in the right way mis-, mal-, pseudo.

e.g., misuse, misunderstanding, malfunction, malnutrition, pseudo intellectual.

- **Prefixes of Time and Order:**

fore-, pre-, post-, ex-, re-.

Examples: fore warn, pre-war, post-war, ex-president, reappear.

- **Prefixes that change word-class:**

Be-, en-, a-

These three convert the base into different word class.

e.g., bewitch, empower, astray

Negative Prefixes:

- **A prefix is s syllable which is put at the beginning of a word to get another word. The prefix need not have only meaning in isolation. Yet they can change the meaning of the word. For example, by putting the prefix 'im' before the word 'polite', we get the word 'impolite' which is the opposite.**
- The following prefixes reverse or negate the meaning of the word: a, de, il-, im-, in-, ir-, dis-, mis-, non-, un-.

Example:

a – (moral – amoral)

de – (centralize – decentralize)

dis – (respect – disrespect)

il – (logical – illogical), (legal – illegal)

WRITING SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS & SPECIFICATIONS

Requirements Engineering, SRS Formulation, & Technical Language Rules

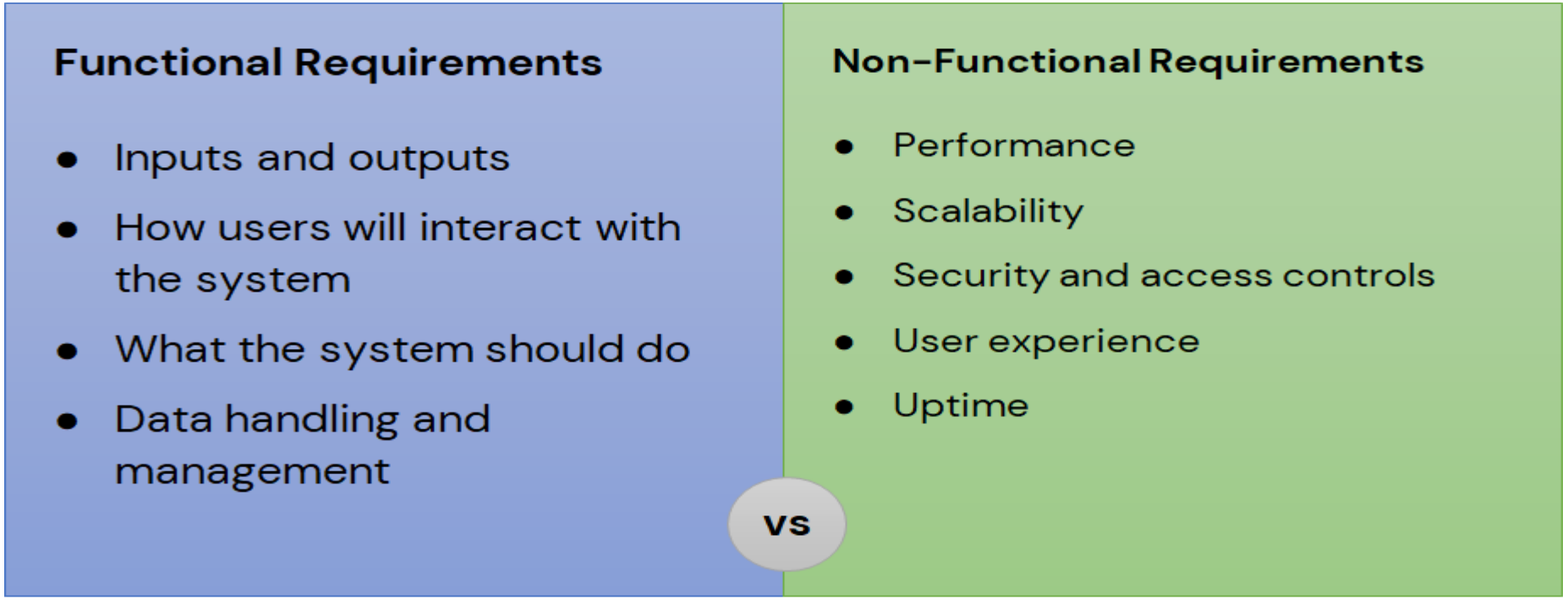
Lecture 4

1. Executive Summary & Context

- In the software development lifecycle (SDLC), **Requirements Engineering (RE)** bridges the gap between high-level business goals and implementation-level code. More software projects fail due to poor, ambiguous, or incomplete requirements than due to technical coding errors.
- For Information Technology professionals, the ability to write precise, clear, and unambiguous specification documents is a foundational skill. This lecture explores the linguistic, structural, and technical methods required to author industry-standard specification documents, primarily the **Software Requirements Specification (SRS)**.

2. Core Terminology & Fundamental Concepts

- Before authoring requirements, a strict distinction between system states, operational constraints, and domain terminology must be established.



2.1 The Requirement Construct

- A requirement is a statement that identifies a product or process operational constraint, characteristic, or attribute that must be verified and is contractually binding.

2.2 System vs. Software Requirements

- **System Requirements Specification (SyRS):** High-level operational needs of an entire system combining hardware, software, human operators, and physical infrastructure.
- **Software Requirements Specification (SRS):** Detailed breakdown focusing exclusively on the software features, data behaviors, interfaces, and external constraints.

3. The Taxonomy of Requirements

- Requirements are classified into two major categories: **Functional Requirements (FRs)** and **Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)**.

3.1 Functional Requirements (FRs)

Functional requirements define the core functions, processing logic, data transformations, and interactions that the system must perform

Structure:

[Subject] + [Modal Verb] + [System Action] + [Object] + [Condition/Context]

Focus: Inputs, transformations, system state changes, and outputs.

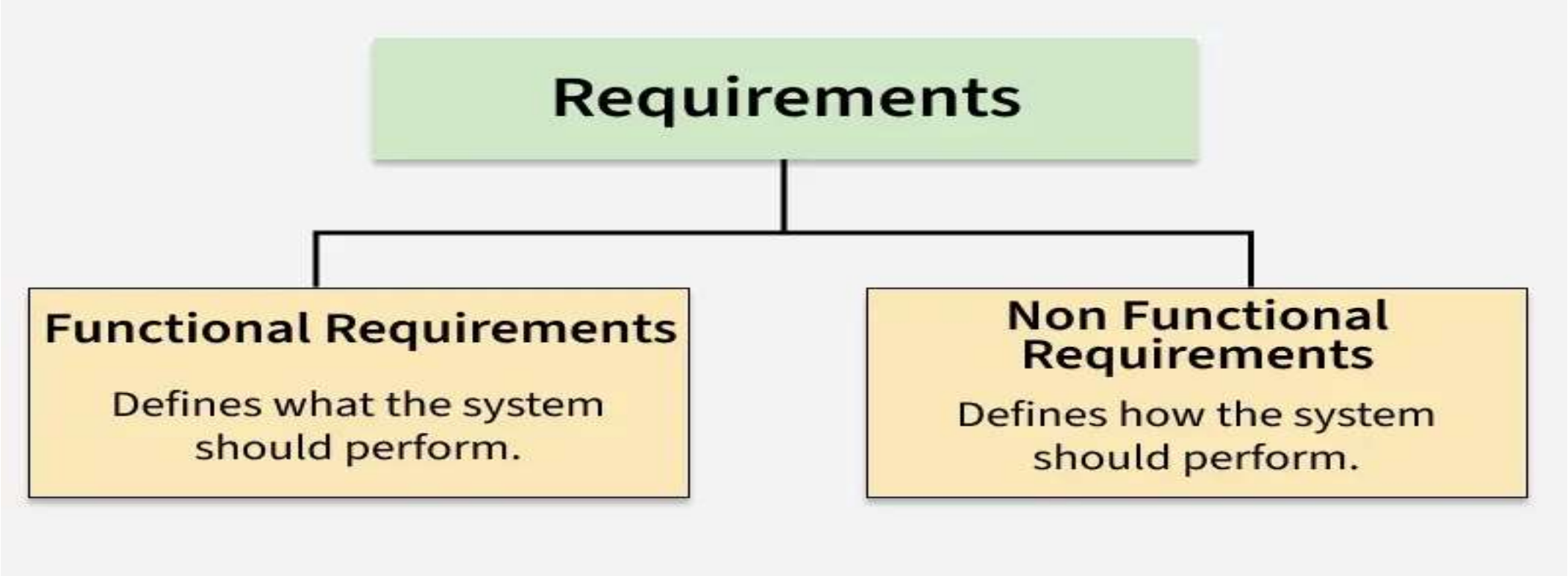
Example: *The Authentication Module shall lock a user account for 15 minutes when three consecutive invalid login attempts occur within a 5-minute window.*

Functional Categories

- **User Authentication & Authorization:** Access control, identity validation, role-based controls.
- **Data Processing & Storage:** CRUD operations (Create, Read, Update, Delete), transaction handling, validation rules.
- **External Interface Interactions:** Data transfers via APIs, integration with third-party payment gateways or messaging queues.
- **Business Logic Execution:** Domain-specific calculations (e.g., tax calculation algorithms, routing protocols).

3.2 Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs / Quality Attributes)

- Non-functional requirements describe **how well** the system performs its functions. They dictate system properties and quality attributes



NFR Category	Technical Focus	Bad Example (Vague)	Good Example (Quantified & Testable)
Performance	Latency, Throughput, Resource Usage	The system must load pages quickly.	The web application shall render the dashboard within 1.5 seconds under a load of 500 concurrent active users.
Security	Encryption, Authentication, Confidentiality	The database must be secure from hackers.	The system shall encrypt all sensitive user data at rest using AES-256 and in transit using TLS 1.3.
Availability / Reliabilit	Uptime, Mean Time Between Failures	The system should almost never go down	The core API service shall maintain an operational uptime of 99.95% per

SOFTWARE & PROCESS DOCUMENTATION

Software User Manuals, Process Description, API Documentation, & Troubleshooting Guides

1. Executive Summary & Context

- In the modern IT ecosystem, software is only as good as its documentation. **Software & Process Documentation** refers to the structured written materials, visual guides, and technical specifications that accompany software products to assist end-users, system administrators, and software engineers.

While **Requirements Specifications (SRS)** focus on *what to build*, **Software & Process Documentation** focuses on:

1. **How to use the software** (*User Documentation / End-User Manuals*).
2. **How the internal processes flow** (*Process Descriptions & Architecture Diagrams*).
3. **How systems integrate** (*API Documentation*).
4. **How to diagnose and repair failures** (*Troubleshooting Guides & Post-Mortems*).

2. Core Principles of Technical Writing for Software

Effective software documentation adheres to five fundamental pillars of technical communication:

1. **Conciseness.**
2. **Clarity.**
3. **Consistency.**
4. **Accuracy.**
5. **Accessibility.**

User Documentation & User Manuals

A **User Manual** (or User Guide) provides step-by-step instructions enabling non-technical or technical end-users to operate a software application effectively.

3.1 Structural Standard for a User Manual

1. Title Page & Document Metadata (Version, Date, Author) .
2. System Requirements / Prerequisites.
3. Getting Started / Installation Guide.
4. Interface Overview & Navigation.
5. Core Tasks / Step-by-Step Procedures.

6. Troubleshooting & Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)
7. Glossary of Terms & Index

4.1 Process Mapping Notation: UML & Flowcharts

Technical writers use standard visual notations to complement written text:

- **UML Activity Diagrams / Flowcharts:** For decision trees and control flow.
- **UML Sequence Diagrams:** For interaction between different software subsystems or APIs.

4.2 Standard Process Description Template

When documenting a system process, include the following structural elements:

1. **Process Title:** Clear name (e.g., *User Password Reset Workflow*).
2. **Objective:** What this process achieves.
3. **Triggers:** What initiates the process (e.g., *User clicks "Forgot Password"*).
4. **Inputs:** Required data or conditions before execution.
5. **Execution Steps:** Sequential list of actions taken by actors/systems.
6. **Outputs:** Resulting state, data saved, or notifications

Technical Incident Report

LECTURE 5 & LECTURE 6

1. Introduction

A **Technical Incident Report** is a formal document used to record and explain a technical problem or unexpected event.

It provides information about:

- What happened?
- When did it happen?
- Where did it happen?
- What was affected?

- What caused the problem?
- What actions were taken?
- How was the problem solved?
- How can we prevent it from happening again?

2. What is a Technical Incident?

A **technical incident** is an unexpected event that affects a computer system, network, software, hardware, database, or IT service.

Examples of Technical Incidents

- Network failure
- Server failure
- Computer virus infection
- Database failure
- Software error

3. Purpose of a Technical Incident Report

The main purposes are:

1. Documentation

To create an official record of the incident.

2. Investigation

To identify what caused the problem.

3. Communication

To communicate the incident to managers, IT staff, or other responsible people.

4. Problem Resolution

To record how the problem was solved.

5. Prevention

To help prevent the same problem from happening again.

4. Main Parts of a Technical Incident Report

A Technical Incident Report normally contains:

1. Title
2. Incident Information
3. Description of the Incident
4. Impact
5. Investigation
6. Root Cause

7. Actions Taken

8. Resolution

9. Recommendations

10. Conclusion

6. Complete Example

Technical Incident Report – Network Failure

Incident Information

Incident Date: 20 September 2026

Incident Time: 10:30 AM

Location: Computer Laboratory

System: University Network

Reported By: IT Support Team

Severity: High

Description of the Incident

At 10:30 AM, the Internet connection stopped working in the computer laboratory. Students and staff were unable to access online services.

Impact

The incident affected 25 computers in the laboratory. Students were unable to access the university's online learning system.

Investigation

The IT support team checked the network cables, switch, router, and server connection. The router configuration was also examined.

Root Cause

The investigation showed that a configuration error caused the router to stop providing Internet access.

Actions Taken

The IT team corrected the configuration and restarted the router. The network connection was then tested on several computers.

Resolution

Internet access was successfully restored at 12:15 PM.

Recommendations

It is recommended that router configurations be backed up regularly and network devices be monitored to prevent similar incidents.

Conclusion

The network incident was successfully investigated and resolved. Normal Internet services were restored to the computer laboratory.

7. Difference Between Incident Report and Technical Report

Incident Report	Technical Report
Reports a **problem or incident**.	Reports a **technical topic or study**.
Explains **what happened**.	Explains **what was studied**.
Focuses on the **cause and solution**.	Focuses on **analysis and results**.
Written after an **incident occurs**.	Can be written **without an incident**.
Example: **Server Failure**	Example: **Server Performance Analysis**

8. Qualities of a Good Incident Report

A good Technical Incident Report should be:

1. Clear

The information should be easy to understand.

2. Accurate

The information should be correct.

3. Objective

The report should present facts rather than personal opinions.

4. Concise

The report should not contain unnecessary information.

5. Organized

Information should be presented in a logical order.

6. Specific

The report should include exact dates, times, systems, and actions whenever possible.

Network and Security Policies

1. Introduction

A **Network and Security Policy** is a set of rules and guidelines used to protect a computer network, its systems, and its data.

2. What is a Network Policy?

A **Network Policy** defines how users and devices should use the network.

Examples

- Who can access the network?
- What devices can connect?
- Which websites can users access?
- What services can users use?
- How much network access does each user have?

3. What is a Security Policy?

A **Security Policy** is a set of rules designed to protect information systems, networks, and data from security threats.

Security threats include:

- Viruses
- Malware
- Hacking
- Unauthorized access
- Data theft
- Password attacks

4. Why Are Network and Security Policies Important?

Network and security policies help organizations to:

1. Protect data.
2. Prevent unauthorized access.
3. Protect network resources.
4. Reduce security risks.
5. Control user access.
6. Respond to security incidents.

5. Main Components of a Security Policy

A security policy may include:

1. Password Policy
2. Access Control Policy
3. Internet Usage Policy
4. Email Policy
5. Data Protection Policy
6. Backup Policy
7. Incident Response Policy

Network Policy vs. Security Policy

Network Policy	Security Policy
Controls network usage	Protects systems and data
Controls users and devices	Protects against threats
Defines network access	Defines security rules
Focuses on network resources	Focuses on security

Key Difference

Network Policy:

Controls how the network is used.

Security Policy:

Defines how systems, networks, and data are protected.

Professional IT Correspondence

Lecture 8

1. Introduction

Professional IT correspondence refers to written communication used by IT professionals in the workplace. It includes emails, formal letters, memos, reports, requests, notices, and other forms of professional communication.

2.Definition of :

- **Professional Correspondence:**

Professional correspondence is formal written communication used in a workplace, organization, or academic environment.

- **Definition of IT Correspondence:**

IT correspondence refers to professional written communication related to information technology, computer systems, software, hardware, networks, databases, technical support, and IT projects.

3. Importance of Professional IT Correspondence

Professional correspondence is important because IT professionals communicate with different people every day.

They communicate with:

- Managers
- Clients
- Customers
- Developers
- System administrators
- Network engineers
- Technical support teams
- University staff
- Other departments

4. Functions of Professional IT Correspondence

- Professional correspondence performs several functions.

1. Information
2. Request
3. Notification
4. Complaint
5. Confirmation
6. Explanation

5. Types of IT Correspondence

1. Professional Email.
2. Formal Letter.
3. Technical Request.
4. Technical Support Message
5. Project Update
6. Meeting Invitation
7. Complaint

A professional email is an electronic message used to communicate formally in a workplace or academic environment.

6. Characteristics of Professional IT Correspondence

- Effective IT correspondence should be:
- Clear
- Concise
- Correct
- Complete
- Professional
- Polite

7.Structure of a Professional Email

1. To
2. Subject
3. Greeting
4. Opening
5. Main message
6. Closing
7. Signature

Example

To: manager@example.com

Subject: Request for System Maintenance

Dear Mr. Ahmed,

I am writing to request system maintenance for the computer laboratory.

The computers in Laboratory 2 have been experiencing network connection problems. We would appreciate your assistance in checking the network configuration.

Please let us know when the maintenance can be performed.

Best regards,
Mohamed Ali
IT Department

8. Formal vs Informal Email

- **Formal:**

example

Dear Dr. Ahmed,

I am writing to request information about the examination

schedule.

Could you please provide the updated schedule?

Kind regards,

Ali Hassan

- **Informal:**

Hi Ahmed,

Can you send me the exam schedule?

Thanks,
Ali

9. Reporting a Technical Problem

- The problem .
- When it happened.
- Where it happened.
- The effect .
- The requested action .

Example

Subject: Network Connection Problem

Dear IT Support Team,

I am writing to report a network connection problem in Laboratory 2.

The computers have been unable to connect to the Internet since 10:00 a.m. today.

This problem is affecting the students' access to online learning materials.

Could you please check the network connection?

Best regards,
Ahmed Hassan